

Final Reflection – Mustafa –

Working on Find My Ride has been a long-term goal for me and I am so happy that I finally had an opportunity to do it in a meaningful way as this. I thought it would basically be about using Kotlin and putting together a UI, but once I actually started building, everything from class gradually started to make sense. Database designs, Chenn Notations, Normalizations, queries were just concepts we talked about before, but when I had to actually decide where to put different pieces of logic, it all clicked. I also figured out that I work way better when I can tackle things bit by bit instead of trying to wrap my head around the entire system at once. Making those connections between what we learned in lectures and actually building the app really showed me why we spent so much time on structure.

Personally speaking, the team part taught me just as much. I realized that I tend to jump into the project manager role-checking in on everyone, making sure things are moving-but the project also showed me where I need to work on myself. Sometimes I try to do too much or just fix something myself instead of waiting for a teammate to finish their piece. This project taught me to *trust the process* more and speak up earlier when something wasn't going the way I expected. Sharing code, getting feedback on my logic, and making sure our designs matched up forced me to get better at explaining what I was thinking. It reminded me that collaboration isn't just splitting up tasks-it's making sure everyone understands how their part connects to everything else.

Technically, this project has tested me to the maximum. Integrating SQLite, debugging those annoying KMP issues on the iOS simulator, getting the navigation to actually work-all of that taught me that sometimes you just have to try things, break the app a bunch of times, and figure it out. I got way more comfortable reading documentation, testing smaller chunks, and taking problems one step at a time instead of freaking out about the whole feature. The whole experience didn't just teach me the tools but how I learn, how I code, and how I work with others. I came out of it with better habits, stronger communication skills, and a real appreciation for building something that actually works from scratch.